

90-DAY SOFTWARE TESTING CAREER ROADMAP

Release Readiness Checklist

Confirm a release is genuinely ready — quality, risk and sign-off.

Introduction

Before a release ships, this checklist confirms the important things are done and the residual risk is understood and accepted. It supports a clear go/no-go decision.

Readiness Checklist

- All high-priority test cases executed
- No open critical or blocking defects
- Regression of impacted and critical areas passed
- Smoke test passes on the release candidate
- Key APIs validated
- Cross-browser/device checks done where relevant
- Known issues documented with severity/priority
- Rollback / hotfix plan understood
- Stakeholders informed of residual risk
- Go/no-go decision recorded and signed off

Real QA Example

For a release you report: "All critical paths pass; two medium defects remain open, neither blocks release; rollback plan confirmed." With that, the business can make an informed go/no-go.

Best Practice Tips

- Lead with risk and impact, not raw test counts.
- Make the residual risk explicit so the decision is informed.
- Capture sign-off — it protects everyone.

Common Mistakes

- Shipping with undocumented known issues.

- No clear go/no-go owner or record.
- Confusing "all tests run" with "ready to release".

INSIDE STLC PRO TIP

Your job at release is to inform the decision, not to make it alone. Present quality and risk clearly and let the business decide.